

ure in the European market. Despite high hopes for 3G services, consumer scepticism may still prove to be a sticking point for the industry. 61 per cent of 6,000 mobile phone owners surveyed in 15 countries, including the UK and the USA, were aware of third-generation services, but only 29 per cent planned to upgrade to a 3G network.

Over 70 per cent of respondents maintained that they had yet to access the Internet over their phones because they did not understand the total 'user experience'. It is expected that an assimilation gap will develop, meaning that the use of 3G services will be notably lower than the penetration rate of 3G phones.

Mobile Entertainment: Mobile Gaming

Mobile gaming is a nascent market. While mobile users are relatively familiar with embedded games such as Snake the concept of wireless gaming is a little less well established. However, will consumers actually be willing to pay to play on their mobiles? A recent survey by research firm Schema found that 35 per cent of gamers they surveyed thought it unlikely that they would play games on a mobile phone. Studies demonstrate that mobile gaming will have to cope more with a lack of time as a barrier to play in addition to the price or even quality of games. Dips in weekday WAP traffic patterns during morning rush hour challenge the assumption that users access mobile services during 'downtime' when travelling.

If consumers have more time to play at home than while on the move then mobile games will be in competition with any 'static' gaming platforms the consumer may have in his or her home.

However, the mobile communication device is one technological artefact that is likely to remain constantly with a user (unlike a GameBoy Advance for example). The mobile gaming industry will have to exploit mobile devices' convenience, personalisation and localisation (through games that tap into location-based information and communication for example).